NO.55 ビタミンＡの重要性とサツマイモ(Ⅰ)

HarvestPlus, an agricultural research organization, is teaching people around the world how to grow what it calls "smart" crops. Its project in Mozambique is having surprising effects. In 2006, HarvestPlus workers provided orange sweet potato plants to people in 24 villages in Mozambique. The workers taught these people how to grow the vegetables. They also explained the importance of Vitamin A to staying healthy.

Farmers in Mozambique had been planting white and yellow sweet potatoes, not the orange-colored ones. The white and yellow potatoes have very little Vitamin A. However, one small, orange sweet potato has a full day's supply of Vitamin A. A lack of Vitamin A is dangerous. Without enough Vitamin A, you face an increased risk of getting a serious disease or dying from infections.

The World Health Organization (WHO) reports that around the world, 190 million young children are not getting enough of this important vitamin in the foods they eat.

Economist Alan de Brauw is with the International Food Policy Research Institute and was involved with the project. He says about 70 percent of children there were Vitamin A deficient. They were not getting enough Vitamin A. "About 70% of kids under the age of five were Vitamin A deficient. So, you have this huge need for new

solutions. If you can do something through agriculture to increase the amount of vitamin in the diet ... you're in much better shape because that's much more sustainable" than using vitamin supplements.

1	organization	名詞	組織(化)・団体
2	preparation	名詞	準備
3	arrangement	名詞	手配・配置・取り決め
4	smart	形容詞	頭のよい・洗練された
5	wise	名詞	(判断・行為などが)賢い
6	crop	名詞	(穀物などの)作物・収穫高
7	harvest	名詞・他動詞	収穫(物・期)・を収穫する
8	grain	名詞	穀物・わずか
9	wheat	名詞	小麦
10	provide	他動詞・自動詞	を提供する・養う・蓄える[for/against]
11	supply	名詞・他動詞	供給(量)・必需品・を供給する
12	equipment	名詞	装備・備品
13	serious	形容詞	重大な・まじめな
14	grave	形容詞	重大な・真剣な・墓穴
15	disease	名詞	病気
16	cancer	名詞	癌・かに座
17	policy	名詞	政策・信条
18	age	名詞・自動詞	年齢・年代・老年・時代・年を取る
19	era	名詞	(政治・歴史上重要な)時代
20	diet	名詞・自動詞	食事・ダイエット・国会・ダイエットする
21	parliament	名詞	議会・国会
22	shape	名詞	状態・形・体形

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